

Post-Operative Instructions

Final Zirconia Implant Prosthesis

Initial Adjustment Period

You may notice your bite feels slightly different at first. This is normal and will improve as your mouth adapts. Speech may take a few days to fully adjust. Reading out loud can help. Increased saliva production is also normal and will decrease as you adjust.

Comfort & Soreness

Mild soreness around the gums is common for a few days after placement. Over-the-counter pain relievers such as ibuprofen or acetaminophen may be taken if needed. If discomfort persists or worsens, contact our office.

Diet

You may gradually return to a normal diet, but please be cautious: Avoid chewing very hard foods (ice, hard candy, bones, unpopped popcorn kernels) as they can fracture the zirconia or damage the implants. Avoid extremely sticky foods (caramels, taffy, chewing gum) which can place undue stress on the prosthesis. Cut tougher foods (steak, crusty bread, apples) into small pieces before chewing. Try to chew evenly on both sides to distribute pressure.

Oral Hygiene

Daily cleaning is essential to the long-term health of your implants and prosthesis. Use a soft-bristled toothbrush to gently brush the prosthesis at least twice daily. Interdental brushes (with nylon-coated wire) or floss made for implants (such as SuperFloss or floss threaders) can help clean under the prosthesis. A water flosser may also be used to flush food particles and plaque from beneath the bridge—just make sure the pressure is not too high. An antimicrobial rinse (such as chlorhexidine or alcohol-free mouthwash) may be recommended—follow your dentist's instructions.

Prosthesis Care

Your zirconia bridge is highly durable but not indestructible. Treat it with care. Do not use your teeth as tools (opening packages, biting fingernails, etc.). If you notice chipping, looseness, or a crack, call our office immediately. The prosthesis is screwed into place and should only be removed by your dentist during maintenance appointments. Do not attempt removal yourself.

Regular Maintenance

Attend all scheduled follow-up visits so your dentist can check the implants, gums, and prosthesis. Professional cleanings every 3–6 months are recommended to remove hard-to-clean buildup around the implants. At these visits, your dentist may remove the prosthesis to clean and inspect it.

What to Watch For

Please contact our office promptly if you notice any of the following: Pain, swelling, or bleeding around the implants; Loosening or movement of the prosthesis; Clicking or unusual noises when chewing; Signs of infection (bad taste, pus, foul odor, fever); Difficulty chewing that does not improve within a week.

Lifestyle Considerations

Smoking and alcohol use can increase the risk of implant failure and should be avoided. If you grind your teeth (bruxism), a nightguard may be recommended to protect your prosthesis. Keep your overall health in check—conditions like diabetes and gum disease can affect implant success.

Long-Term Outlook

With proper care, your zirconia implant prosthesis can last many years. Remember: the implants and supporting gums require just as much attention as natural teeth. Your partnership in daily home care and regular dental checkups is critical for long-term success.

Emergency Contact

If you experience severe pain, swelling, or prosthesis breakage, please call our office immediately at (insert office phone number). For after-hours concerns, follow the emergency instructions on our voicemail.